Commas & Apostrophes (Set B)

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Purple — Getting Started

1. We packed shorts, shirts, socks and sandals.
2. I won't go without my coat.
3. C) The bowl had apples, pears and grapes.
4. Tom's bike.
5. Possession — shows the whiskers belong to the cat.
6. Contraction — short for 'cannot'.
7. A) don't; C) can't; D) it's
8. Please pass the salt, Grandad.
9. B) The dog's bone was buried.
10. the class's homework (one class) — or 'the pupils'' homework' if treating as many pupils; accepted answer: the class's homework.
11. The recipe needs flour, sugar, butter and eggs.
12. C) teachers'
13. Any correct sentence using 'they're' correctly, e.g. 'They're coming to the party.'
14. 'The boy's bag' means one boy owns the bag; 'the boys' bag' means more than one boy owns it (shared).
15. A) Come here, Priya.; D) Thank you, Sam, for your help.

Green — Building Fluency

16. Although it was cold, Maya refused to wear a coat.
17. A comma is needed to separate the fronted subordinate clause from the main clause, showing where the first idea ends.
18. C) Later that evening, the storm arrived.
19. the cats' collars.
20. Because 'children' is already an irregular plural (not ending in -s), the possessive is formed by adding 's, just like a singular noun.
21. A) My uncle, who lives in Spain, is visiting.; E) The dog, a small terrier, barked all night.
22. It's been raining since this morning, so bring an umbrella.
23. C) We saw lions, tigers and bears at the zoo.
24. James's opinions.
25. 'Your' shows possession, e.g. 'Is this your book?' 'You're' is short for 'you are', e.g. 'You're late.'
26. Yes, Miss Patel, I have finished my essay.
27. C) Jack and Jill's house was large.
28. It was a long, cold, tiring journey.
29. Because the apostrophe after the s already shows the plural possessive ('women's' — but note 'women' is already plural so needs 's, not s'); adding a second apostrophe after the final s is incorrect and non-standard.
30. A) The rain stopped, and the sun came out.; D) I wanted to stay, but I had to leave.

Red — Challenge

31. Corrected: 'The chef, who trained in Paris, cooked a rich, delicious meal for the critics, who were very impressed.' Commas are needed around the non-essential clause 'who trained in Paris', between the two listed adjectives 'rich'

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and 'delicious' (removing the wrong comma after 'delicious,'), and before the non-essential clause 'who were very impressed'.

32. 'The dog's bone' = belongs to one dog; 'the dogs' bone' = belongs to more than one dog; 'the dogs bone' (no apostrophe) is NOT standard English — it fails to show possession at all.

33. C) The novel, which won the prize, is on the shelf.

34. It's a shame that the twins' bikes were stolen last night.

35. A) the children's toys; C) the boss's office; D) the ladies' room; E) James' car (also accept James's car)

36. Use 'it's' when you mean 'it is' (e.g. 'It's cold today') or 'it has' (e.g. 'It's been a long day'). 'Its' (no apostrophe) is possessive, e.g. 'The bird flapped its wings.'

37. C) My sister, a talented violinist, will perform tonight.

38. 'The class's trophy' means the trophy belonging to one class; 'the classes' trophy' means a trophy shared by more than one class.

39. Corrected: 'My grandparents, who live in Leeds, are visiting us, and they're bringing the dogs' toys.' Commas are needed around the non-essential clause 'who live in Leeds' and before the conjunction 'and' joining two main clauses; 'their' should be "they're" (they are) and 'dogs' needs an apostrophe to show possession ('dogs'' for more than one dog, or 'dog's' if just one).

40. B) 'I'm leaving now,' said Tom.

41. Add just an apostrophe (no extra s) — e.g. 'James' car' — or add 's as in 'James's car'; both are widely accepted, but the key rule is never to write 'Jamess' car' without any apostrophe.

42. B) Despite the heavy rain, the match continued.; C) Having finished her homework, she went outside.; E) Before the sun rose, the fishermen set off.

43. Any correct sentence with a correctly comma-separated three-item adjective list and one correct possessive apostrophe, both underlined.

44. 'The teachers' staffroom' = the staffroom belonging to more than one teacher; 'the teacher's staffroom' = the staffroom belonging to one teacher.

45. Corrected: 'Although the weather was poor, the team's captain decided the match should continue, because the crowd, who had travelled far, wanted to see it.' Errors: missing comma after the fronted clause 'Although the weather was poor'; 'teams' should be 'team's' (possessive, one team); missing commas around the non-essential clause 'who had travelled far'.

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Purple — Getting Started

1. We bought bread, milk, cheese and jam.
2. I haven't seen that film.
3. C) The bag held pens, pencils and rulers.
4. Aisha's scarf.
5. Possession — shows the nest belongs to the bird.
6. Contraction — short for 'did not'.
7. A) wasn't; C) haven't; D) she's
8. Please close the door, Aunty.
9. B) The cat's bowl was empty.
10. the team's lockers (one team) — accept 'the players'' lockers' if treating as many players.
11. The box contained books, pencils, rulers and crayons.
12. C) doctors'
13. Any correct sentence using 'you're' correctly, e.g. 'You're doing really well.'
14. 'The girl's coat' means one girl owns the coat; 'the girls' coat' means more than one girl owns it (shared).
15. A) Hello, Mr Khan.; D) Please help me, Omar.

Green — Building Fluency

16. Even though she was scared, Lily climbed the ladder.
17. A comma is needed to separate the fronted subordinate clause from the main clause.
18. C) Suddenly, without warning, the alarm sounded.
19. the dogs' leads.
20. Because 'men' is already an irregular plural (not ending in -s), the possessive is formed by adding 's, just like a singular noun.
21. A) My aunt, who lives in Leeds, is visiting.; E) The parrot, a noisy bird, squawked all day.
22. It's been snowing since last night, so wrap up warm.
23. C) We saw elephants, giraffes and zebras at the park.
24. Sara's opinion.
25. 'Whose' shows possession, e.g. 'Whose coat is this?' 'Who's' is short for 'who is' or 'who has', e.g. 'Who's coming?'
26. No, Mr Evans, I have not finished yet.
27. C) Ben and Lucy's project was excellent.
28. It was a bright, warm, cheerful morning.
29. Because the apostrophe is correctly placed after the plural 's' in 'babies'' to show more than one baby; adding an extra apostrophe after an already-correct possessive form is non-standard.
30. A) The bell rang, and the pupils left.; D) I was hungry, but I waited.

Standard / Advanced

31. Corrected: 'The author, who wrote the trilogy, gave a long, fascinating talk to the students, who were thrilled to meet her.' Commas are needed around the non-essential clause 'who wrote the trilogy', between the listed adjectives 'long' and 'fascinating', and before the non-essential clause 'who were thrilled to meet her'.
32. 'The cat's toy' = belongs to one cat; 'the cats' toy' = belongs to more than one cat; 'the cats toy' (no apostrophe) is NOT standard English.
33. C) The painting, which won the award, hangs in the hall.
34. It's odd that the sisters' coats were left outside last night.

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35. A) the puppies' basket; C) the witness's statement; D) the boys' changing room; E) Charles' hat (also accept Charles's hat)
36. Use 'it's' when you mean 'it is' (e.g. 'It's sunny today') or 'it has' (e.g. 'It's rained all week'). 'Its' is possessive, e.g. 'The cat licked its paw.'
37. C) My brother, a keen footballer, will join the team.
38. 'The team's bus' means the bus belonging to one team; 'the teams' bus' means a bus shared by more than one team.
39. Corrected: 'My neighbours, who moved here last year, are friendly, and they're always offering to lend us the dog's lead.' Commas are needed around 'who moved here last year' and before 'and' joining two main clauses; 'theyre' should be "they're"; 'dogs' needs an apostrophe for possession ('dog's' for one dog).
40. B) 'We should leave soon,' said Maya.
41. Add just an apostrophe (e.g. 'Charles' hat') or add 's ('Charles's hat'); both forms are accepted, but never write it with no apostrophe at all.
42. B) In spite of the delay, the train arrived safely.; C) Having waited an hour, we finally boarded.; E) As the sun set, the sky turned orange.
43. Any correct sentence with a correctly comma-separated three-item adjective list and one correct possessive apostrophe, both underlined.
44. 'The players' kit' = kit belonging to more than one player; 'the player's kit' = kit belonging to one player.
45. Corrected: 'Although the forecast was bad, the captain's boat set off, because the sailors, who had trained for months, wanted to compete.' Errors: missing comma after the fronted clause 'Although the forecast was bad'; 'captains' should be "captain's" (possessive — the boat belongs to one captain); missing commas around the non-essential clause 'who had trained for months'.

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